Eggplant with chili and crunchy topping

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Recipe: Serves 2-4

- Oil for frying
- 3 shallots, thinly sliced
- 6 garlic cloves, thinly sliced
- Mint and cilantro to mix with garlic and shallots
- Salt & pepper to taste
- 2 Japanese eggplant
- 2 Tbsp soy sauce
- 3 Tbsp tahini
- 2 Tbsp ice cold water
- 1 Tbsp mirin
- 1/2 lemon juiced
- Chili crisp for topping

1. In a cold pan combine thinly sliced shallots and cold oil. (You'll just need enough oil to cover shallots.)
2. On medium low heat, cook shallots until light golden brown. About 10 minutes. (Be careful they will continue to get darker as you pull them out of oil.)
3. Drain on a paper towel and season with salt.
4. Strain oil and repeat process with the thinly sliced garlic.

5. Let garlic and shallot cool down and mix with cilantro and mint. Set topping aside.
6. Char eggplant over open flame until all sides are black.
7. Place in bowl and cover for at least 20 minutes.
8. Mix soy sauce, tahini, ice cold water, mirin, and lemon juice until all combined. (the ice cold water makes it emulsify easier) Set aside.
9. Peel char off eggplant and cut lengthwise exposing inside flesh.
10. Season with salt and pepper.
11. Top with chili crisp and herb/garlic topping. Serve with reserved tahini sauce.

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